

CRABS



What lives in the sea or on land, can be any color, has its eyes on stalks, swims and walks sideways, and carries its own house? Would you have guessed a crab? Crabs live in all parts of the sea, from the very deepest oceans to wave-swept shores.

Crabs use their back four pairs of legs to scuttle sideways.

The crab uses its strong claws to crush and tear up food, such as hard-shelled shellfish and fish.

Under this spine, there are two feelers, called antennae. The crab uses tiny hairs along the antennae to touch, smell, and taste.

The shell is often called the carapace.

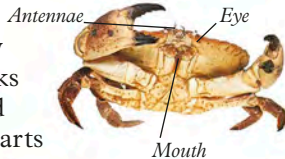
When crabs get too big for their shells they split them open and shed them. Underneath the old suit of armor there is a new, soft shell. It can take up to three days to harden.

This spiny spider crab is protected from most of its enemies by its shell.

Crab eaters

Crabs make a tasty meal for fish, birds, octopuses, seals, and people!

Crabby face



Crabs can grow new legs if they are torn off.

Crabs breathe through five pairs of gills. These are inside the shell, near the top of each leg.

Joint

